

The 6th Saudi International Physiotherapy Conference

Advancing Physiotherapy in Saudi Arabia: Leadership, Innovation & Value-Based Impact



DAY 1 — Thursday 12 November 2026

Time	Session Type	Title	Speaker
7:30–8:00	Registration		
8:00–8:10	Opening remarks		
		Session 1: Strategic Leadership & Health System Integration	Moderator: Dr. Ahmad Alghamdi
8:10–8:40	Keynote	Physiotherapy's Role in Saudi Health System Transformation	Dr. Faisal Aldahmashi
8:40–9:45	Focused symposium	Direct Access Implementation Evidence & Saudi Experience: • Opening & Framing • Evidence Presentation • Saudi Experience Case Study • Implementation Framework – Practical roadmap	Dr. Asma Alrushud Dr. Hani Alabbad Dr. Hosam Alzahrani Dr. Hani Alabbad
9:45–10:00	Q&A		
10:00–10:15	Break		
10:15–11:00	Opening ceremony		
11:00–11:40	Panel (1)	Rehabilitation Governance & National Standards: Building a Unified Physiotherapy Framework	Moderator: Dr. Mishal Aldaihan Panelists: 1. Dr. Faisal Aldahmashi 2. Dr. Hanan Alsaif 3. Dr. Noora Alshoweir 4. Mr. Talal Alghamdi
11:40–11:50	Q&A		
11:50–13:00	Lunch		
		Session 2: Advanced Musculoskeletal & Sports Rehabilitation	Moderator: Dr. Abdulaziz Alomerani
13:00–13:30	Keynote	Redefining Chronic Pain Care: Integrating Biopsychosocial & Value-Based Physiotherapy Models (Virtual Lecture)	Prof. Lorimer Moseley
13:30–13:50	Invited	Evidence-Based Return-to-Sport Decision-Making in Modern Rehabilitation	Prof. Qassim Muaidi
13:50–14:10	Invited	Speaking Up in Elite Sport - Barriers and Enablers Faced by Physiotherapists	Dr. Sian Knott
14:10–14:30	Invited	Integrating Evidence, Experience & Patient Context: Advanced Decision-Making in Musculoskeletal Physiotherapy	Prof. Ali Alshami

Time	Session Type	Title	Speaker
14:30–14:40	Platform presentation (1)	Effects of Nigella sativa Supplementation with Combined Exercise on Musculoskeletal Performance and Blood Fructosamine Levels in Male Adults with Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus: A Randomized Controlled Trial	Dr. Hiedar Alyami
14:40–14:50	Platform presentation (2)	The Impact of Autonomic Nervous System Modulation on Heart Rate Variability and Musculoskeletal Manifestations in Chronic Neck Pain: A Double-Blind Randomized Clinical Trial	Dr. Hani Alkhawajah
14:50–15:00	Platform presentation (3)	Comparative Effectiveness of Cognitive Functional Therapy, Exercise, and Multimodal Rehabilitation for Chronic Low Back Pain: A Systematic Review and Network Meta-Analysis of Randomized Controlled Trials	Mr. Abdullah Alessa
15:00–15:10	Q&A		
15:10–15:40	Break		
		Session 3: Advanced Rehabilitation Across Specialties	Moderator: Dr. Batool Alhassan
15:40–16:00	Invited	Redefining Cardiopulmonary & ICU Rehabilitation in Modern Healthcare	Prof. Ali Albarrari
16:00–16:20	Invited	Preparing Physical Therapists for Older Adults: Development and Evaluation of an Arabic Educational Intervention on Ageism	Dr. Maha Almarwani
16:20–16:40	Invited	Pelvic Health & Beyond: Evidence-Based Physiotherapy for Women	Prof. Heba Embabi
16:40–16:50	Platform presentation (4)	Effects of High-Intensity Interval Training on Body Composition, Blood Pressure, and Cardiorespiratory Fitness in Obese Hypertensive Men: A Randomized Controlled Trial	Mr. Mahdi Al Ghannam
16:50–17:00	Platform presentation (5)	Effect of Pulsed High-Intensity Laser Therapy Combined with Exercise Protocol in Treatment of Primary Dysmenorrhea: A Randomized Controlled Trial	Ms. Saeeda Alhashmi Alamir
17:00–17:10	Platform presentation (6)	The Effect of Vitamin D Supplementation on Pediatric Skeletal Muscle Strength	Mr. Naif Bin-Talha
17:10–17:20	Q&A		
17:20–17:50	Panel (2)	Integrated & Interdisciplinary Models of Care	Moderator: Dr. Sara Almansouri Panelists: 1. Dr. Walid Ouanes 2. Dr. Tahany Alhamad 3. Dr. Mohammed Alhaizan 4. Dr. Faisal Al Mubarak
17:50–18:00	Q&A		
18:00	END OF THE DAY (1)		



DAY 2 — Friday 13 November 2026

Time	Session Type	Title	Speaker
		Session 4: Neurological Rehabilitation Across the Lifespan	Moderator: Dr. Sattam Almutairi
13:30–14:00	Keynote	Neuroplasticity in Action: Translating Brain Science into High-Impact Stroke Rehabilitation	Dr.Turki Abualait
14:00–14:20	Invited	Optimizing Neurodevelopment: Advancing Pediatric Neurorehabilitation Through Early, Intensive & Family-Centered Care	Dr. Veronika Vasilcova
14:20–14:40	Invited	Rehabilitation Strategies for Neurodegenerative Disorders: Care paths to Improve Mobility, Function, and Quality of Life Across the Continuum of Care (Virtual Lecture)	Dr. Miriam Rafferty
14:40–14:50	Platform presentation (7)	The effects of trunk rehabilitation on balance, gait, falls, and community mobility in patients with multiple sclerosis	Ms. Shatha Mukhtar
14:50–15:00	Platform presentation (8)	Using Transcranial Direct Current Stimulation to Improve Multiple Domains in Health-Related Quality of Life among Subacute Stroke Survivors	Dr. Mohammed Alshehri
15:00–15:10	Platform presentation (9)	Integrating AI and IoT-Enabled Assistive Technologies in Post-Stroke Neurorehabilitation: A Value-Based Framework	Dr. Fayez Namnaqani
15:10–15:20	Q&A		
15:20–15:50	Break / Exhibition		

Time	Session Type	Title	Speaker
		Session 5: Digital Rehabilitation and Workforce Development	Moderator: Dr. Hani Alkhawajah
15:50–16:20	Keynote	AI-Assisted Assessment and Treatment in Physiotherapy Practice	Dr. Mashael Alsobhi
16:20–16:40	Invited	Residency, Specialization, & Competency Frameworks	Dr. Terrence McGee
16:40–17:00	Invited	Challenges with Telehealth and How To Overcome Them (Virtual Lecture)	Prof. Rana Hinman
17:00–17:10	Platform presentation (10)	Gamified Vs Standard Step-Counting Applications: Effects on Daily Step Count and Sleep Quality in University Students	Dr. Rehab Aljuhni
17:10–17:20	Platform presentation (11)	Bridging the Cognitive Gap: AI-Assisted Quantitative Movement Analysis for Enhanced Clinical Reasoning in Musculoskeletal Physical Therapy	Ms. Noor Alzahri
17:20–17:30	Platform presentation (12)	Beyond the Tendon: Whole-Body Compensatory Movement Patterns in Athletes with Patellar Tendinopathy Identified by AI-Assisted Motion Analysis	Mr. Abdullah Alharbi
17:30–17:40	Q&A		
17:40–18:10	Panel (3)	The Future of Physiotherapy in Saudi Arabia:	Moderator: Dr. Asma Alderaa Panelists: 1. Dr. Abdulfattah Alqahtani 2. Dr. Terrence McGee 3. Dr. Ahamd Barhameen 3. Ms. Manar Almkirsh
18:10–18:20	Q&A		
18:20–19:00		Closing Remarks & Awards Ceremony	
19:00		END OF THE DAY (2)	